

Corporate & Event Catering Operational Guidelines

On-Site Food Service Management, Safety, and Service Excellence

1. Scope of Operations

This document establishes the structural frameworks, safety protocols, and operational workflows required for all on-site corporate hospitality, banquets, and external event catering functions. Compliance with these criteria is mandatory for all culinary, setup, and service personnel.

2. Dietary Compliance & Allergen Control

In modern corporate hospitality, allergen cross-contamination management is critical. The kitchen must follow explicit separation workflows during event preparation:

- **Allergen Labeling:** All buffet menu item placards must clearly articulate the presence of any of the top major allergens (Molluscs, Crustaceans, Fish, Eggs, Peanuts, Soy, Milk, Tree Nuts, Celery, Mustard, Sesame, Sulphites, Lupin, and Gluten).
- **Cross-Contact Avoidance:** Distinct preparation surfaces, color-coded cutting boards, and dedicated utensils must be assigned to allergen-free and specialized lifestyle menu items (e.g., Halal, Vegan, Gluten-Free).
- **On-Site Segregation:** When setting up buffet lines, specialized dietary dishes must occupy a standalone satellite table or be separated by a minimum physical distance of one meter from standard offerings.

3. Buffet Line and Holding Protocols

Maintaining optimal presentation and food safety on a live service line requires continuous verification and adherence to the following timelines:

Service Stage	Standard Equipment Utilized	Monitoring Protocol / Frequency
Pre-Service Set	Electric chafing dishes, sternos, crushed ice wells.	Verify pre-heating/chilling elements 30 minutes before guest arrival.
Hot Holding	Water-pan induction warmers (maintained at min. 65°C).	Log core temperature with a calibrated probe every 30 minutes.
Cold Holding	Insulated ice beds or refrigerated counter units (max. 4°C).	Log ambient ice-well temp every 45 minutes; replace melted ice immediately.

The Two-Hour/Four-Hour Rule:

Any perishable food item held at ambient temperature (within the danger zone of 5°C to 60°C) for less than two hours may be returned to refrigeration or consumed. If held between two and four hours, it must be consumed immediately. Any item exceeding four hours in the danger zone must be immediately discarded.

4. Logistics, Breakdown, and Waste Management

4.1 Transportation Mechanics

Prepared meals transported from central production kitchens to venue locations must be secured in heavy-duty insulated catering food pan carriers (e.g., Cambro units). Hot items must be loaded directly from the ovens at a minimum temperature of 75°C to offset minor thermal drop during transit.

4.2 Post-Event Cleardown

Immediately following event closure, all leftover foods must be categorized. Items that have sat on the active buffet line must be cleared and logged as organic food waste. They cannot be packaged for client consumption or staff donation due to exposure risks. Event venues must be swept, sanitized, and returned to original configurations within two hours of event conclusion.